

Science Corps Fellowship Application

Thank you for your interest in becoming a Science Corps Fellow. Please complete all required fields. We review applications on a rolling basis.

First Name *

Kanika

Last Name *

Rawat

Email *

kanikarawat59@gmail.com

Gender

☐

Male

☒

Female

☐

Non-Binary

Residence: City (State), Country *

Bengaluru (Karnataka), India

Nationality *

Indian

When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD? (month and year) *

Feb 2026

Please indicate the university where you earned (or are currently pursuing) your PhD *

Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru

Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow? *

I was fortunate to spend a month teaching students at the Indian Institute of Science, and I found the experience deeply rewarding. It sparked my interest in pursuing longer-term teaching opportunities. As I plan to take a break from research for at least a semester, teaching offers a way to remain engaged with science. The possibility of doing this abroad is especially appealing: experiencing different culture and experiencing a different academic environment would make for a uniquely enriching chapter in my career. I am particularly drawn to opportunities where my teaching and mentorship could have an impact on students with limited access to such experiences.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science *
Corps Fellow.

Taught animal behaviour to bachelor's, master's, and PhD students as a Guest Lecturer at IISc (2025)

Trained eight bachelor's students and five project assistants in study design, behavioural observations, data entry, mosquito handling, and experiments (2020-2024)

Mentored three master's and two bachelor's theses (2022-2023)

Taught BSc and PhD students and assisted with a course on study design, statistics, and R programming (2021)

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply. *

- ☒ Scientist in academia
- ☐ Doing science in industry
- ☐ Administrative role in industry or academia
- ☒ In science education
- ☐ In science outreach
- ☐ Other:

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally *
in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

I envision pursuing a postdoctoral position in another country and a different research setup, transitioning from behavioural ecology into neuroethology. My goal would be to acquire a different set of skills that would allow me to investigate the mechanistic basis of behaviour, particularly the role of neural circuits and neurons in shaping evolutionarily conserved behaviours. This interdisciplinary training, combined with my ecological and evolutionary background, would enable me to address questions from multiple perspectives.

Looking ahead ten years, if I am fortunate, I see myself returning to India and holding a research position in ecology and evolution. I would like to lead a research program, mentor PhD students, and teach both undergraduate and graduate students. At the same time, I am open to the possibility that my path may become more teaching-focused. In that case, I would be equally fulfilled teaching undergraduate and graduate students in government-run colleges, helping to make science education more accessible and inspire the next generation of scientists.

How did you find out about Science Corps? *

- ☒ An email list in your institution
- ☐ A post on a job-site
- ☐ An entry in a post-doc search resource (e.g., ecoevjobs.net)
- ☐ Referred by a previous fellow
- ☐ Referred by a friend/colleague/supervisor in academia
- ☐ Other:

Upload your CV / resume *



Kanika_Rawat_C...



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